

SCHOOL BOARD OWNED/LEASED VEHICLE OPERATIONS

The Loudoun County School Board owns and leases vehicles in support of instruction and non-instruction programs. Loudoun County School Board employees operating a school board owned or leased vehicle must be properly trained and operate vehicles safely in accordance with the Code of Virginia.

A. Hiring, Licensing and Operation

1. Loudoun County Public Schools will not hire, employ, or enter into any agreement with any person for the purposes of operating a school bus transporting students unless the person has met all conditions of such employment as dictated by the Code of Virginia, Virginia Administrative Code, Virginia Department of Education, and Loudoun County Public Schools' policy.

2. All employees who are assigned a Loudoun County Public Schools' licensed motor vehicle must possess a valid operator's license. Employees shall allow Loudoun County Public Schools to obtain such Virginia Department of Motor Vehicles transcripts via written permission for no fee. Driving a Loudoun County Public Schools vehicle is a privilege, not a right, and employees operating such vehicles without a valid operator's license or demonstrating a pattern of poor driving or driving that results in traffic citations will be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

3. The Loudoun County School Board shall own, lease and operate such motor vehicles as shall be necessary for instructional program support and student transportation. Further, certain designated vehicles will be used for support activities for the maintenance of buildings and grounds, support of the school lunch program, security, and specified administrative functions. Such vehicles should not exceed 15 years of age unless deemed to be in safe and functional operational condition and shall meet current safety standards. When practical, LCPS shall give preference for vehicles that have a reduced impact on the environment, such as electric vehicles. All Loudoun County Public Schools vehicles shall have equipment installed that utilizes the global positioning system (GPS) or other electronic location services and automatic vehicle location (AVL).

4. Publicly owned school buses may be used only for purposes connected with public school programs or public purposes designated by the Superintendent or their designee. Each such authorization shall provide for reimbursing the School Board in full for the proportionate share of any and all costs.

B. In-Service Training. In-service training shall be conducted prior to the beginning of the school year and the start of the second half of the school year for all school bus drivers. This shall include how to maximize benefits of safety programs and components.

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C. Operator Safety Belts Required. Any operator of an LCPS school bus or licensed motor vehicle must use the safety restraint system provided in the vehicle while the vehicle is in motion.

D. School Bus and Vehicle Safety

1. All school buses and other vehicles owned and operated by Loudoun County Public Schools will be inspected for safety in accordance with the regulations prescribed by the Department of Education as well as guidance provided by Loudoun County Public School Division of Transportation.

2. All accidents, regardless of the damage involved, must be reported to the police at the time of the accident as well as LCPS Dispatch by calling 571-252-1700.

3. Wireless telecommunications devices or other devices, whether handheld or otherwise, may not be used while driving a school bus, except in the case of an emergency or when the vehicle is lawfully parked and for the purposes of dispatching. Nothing in this section shall be construed to prohibit the use of two-way radio devices or wireless telecommunications devices that are used hands free to allow live communication between the driver and school or public safety officials which have been authorized for use by the Director of Transportation.

[Former Policies 6-14, 6-15, 6-16, 6-17, 6-18]

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Leg Refs: Va. Code Ann. §§ [22.1-78](#), [22.1-176](#), [22.1-182](#), [22.1-198](#), [46.2-919.1](#), [8 VAC 20-70-90](#), [8 VAC 20-70-130](#), [8 VAC 20-70-140](#), [8 VAC 20-70-380](#)